

CARDAMOMPULSE · A DATA ALMANAC

The Cardamom Almanac

What the price has been trying to tell us

Eleven years. 5,440 auctions. One small green pod whose price has swung nine-fold. Here is what the numbers say about when to sell, when to plant, and where the market really gets made.

Rs 495

record low (2016-03)

Rs 4,675

all-time peak (2019-08)

9.4x

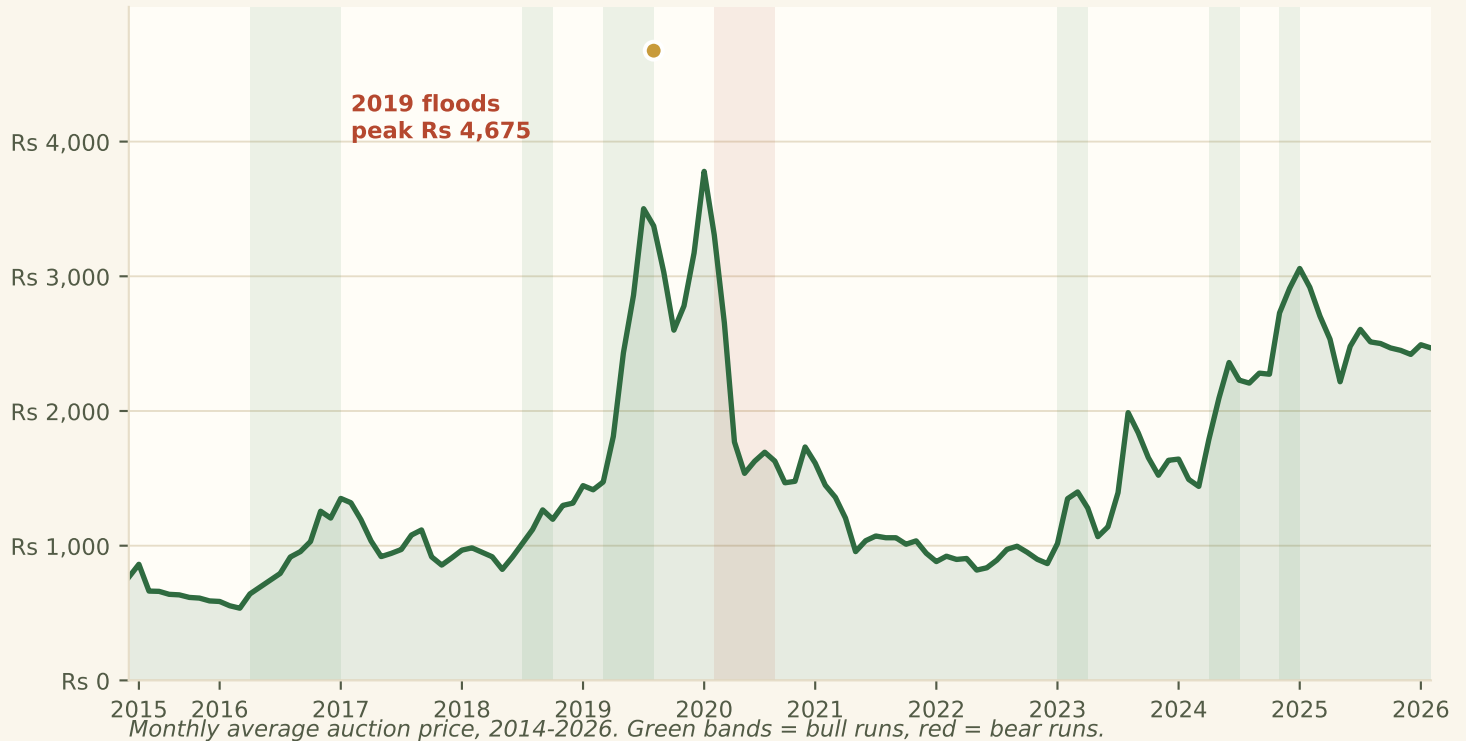
peak-to-trough swing

+256%

biggest 6-mo rally

A price with a temper

Few farm commodities move like cardamom. Since 2014 the auction price has travelled from under Rs 500 to nearly Rs 4,700 a kilo and back - driven by monsoons, floods and the slow churn of planting cycles.



Rs 4,675

2019 flood peak

-67%

2020 crash

+256%

2019 rally

Rs 2,505

latest print

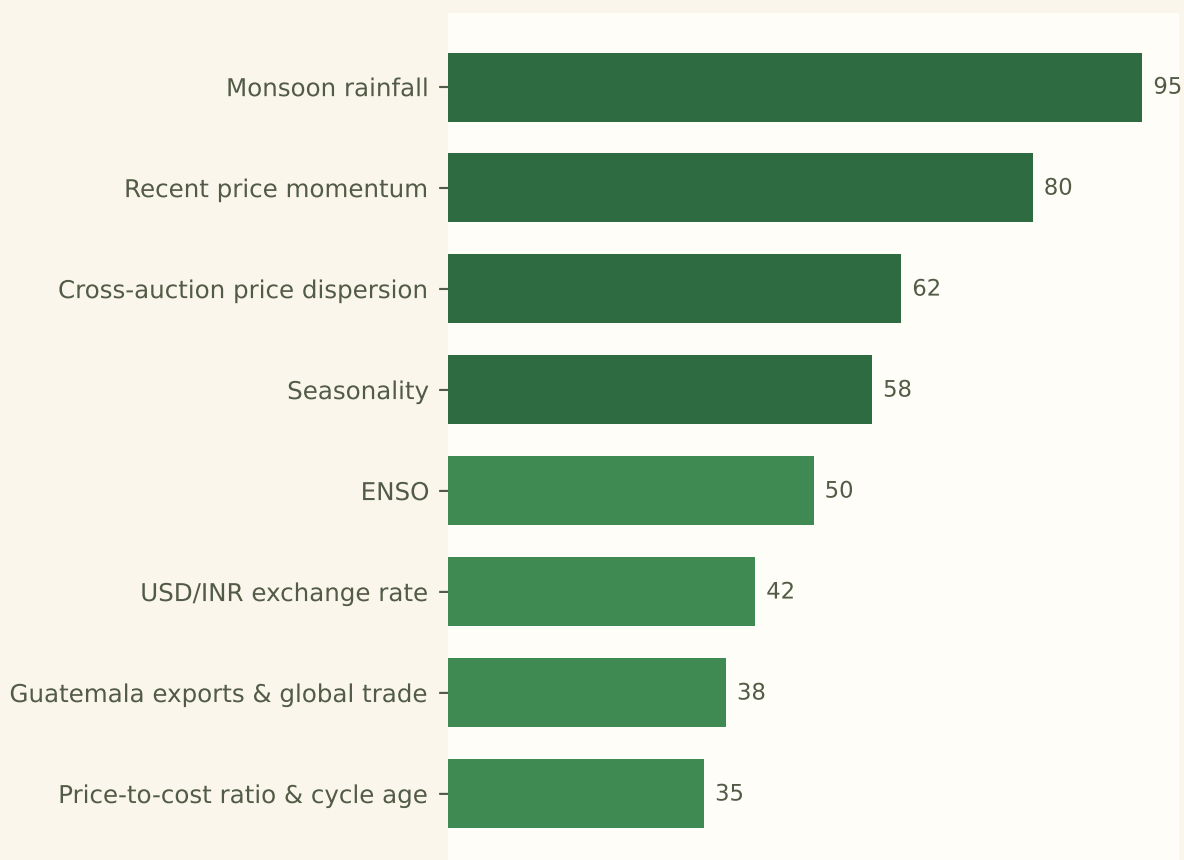
WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

Cardamom is a boom-and-bust crop. The biggest fortunes - and ruins - were made by those who read the cycle, not the week. The 2019 flood spike to Rs 4,675 was followed by a two-thirds collapse. Plan for the swing; never assume today's price is the new normal.

"The market spends years quietly cheap, then re-prices violently in a single season."

What actually moves the price

We ranked every signal by how much it improves a real, out-of-sample price forecast. The verdict is humbling for chartists: weather wins.



Relative predictive influence (higher = more useful).

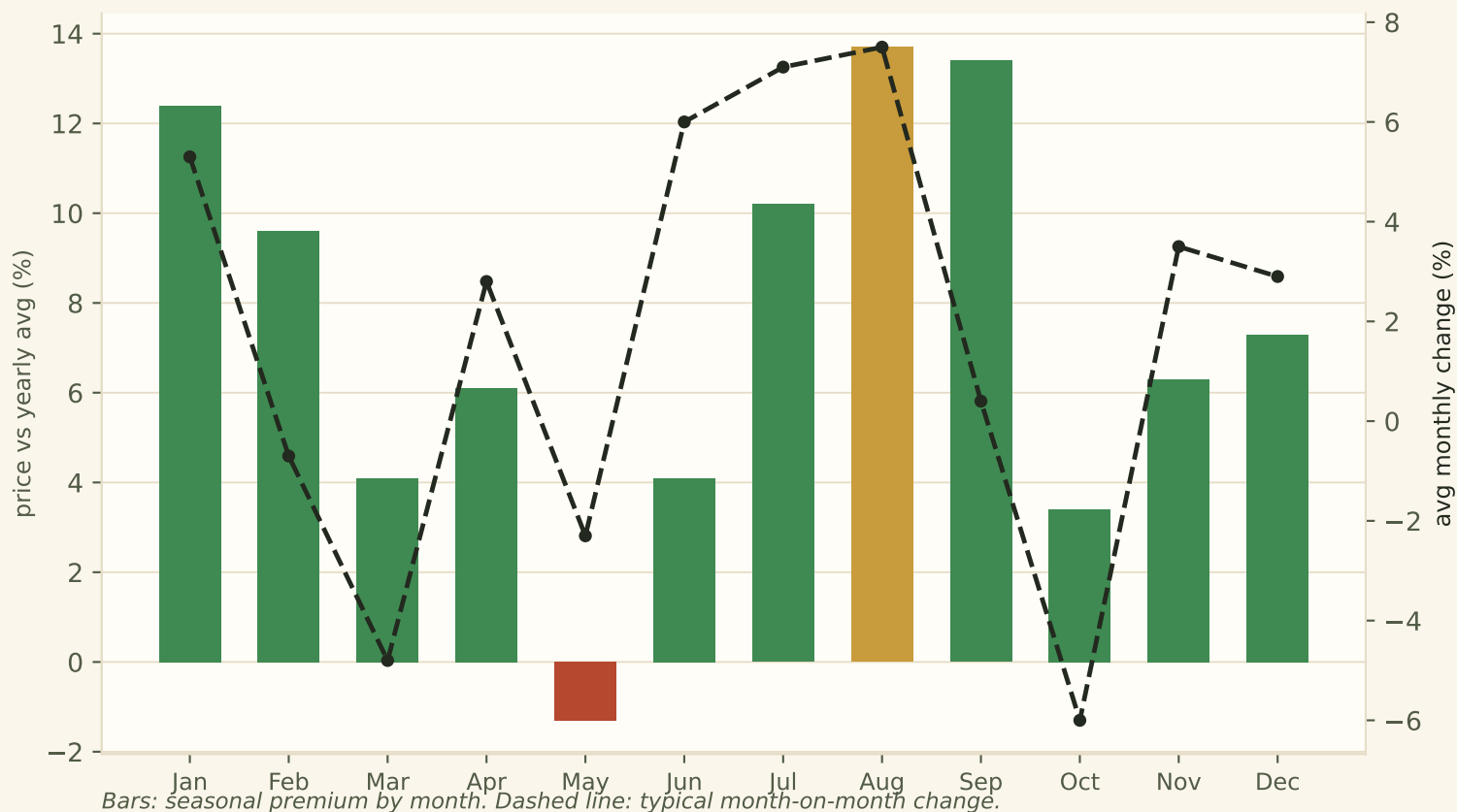
WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

Over a season, monsoon rainfall in Idukki is the master variable - it shapes next year's supply more than any price chart. Watch the rains, the El Nino / La Nina cycle, and the rupee. Day to day, price momentum and how much the auction houses disagree matter most.

"Watch the rains, not the rumours."

The selling calendar

Strip away the long-term trend and a clear yearly rhythm appears. Some months reliably pay more - and one month reliably punishes those who wait.



BEST WINDOW TO SELL

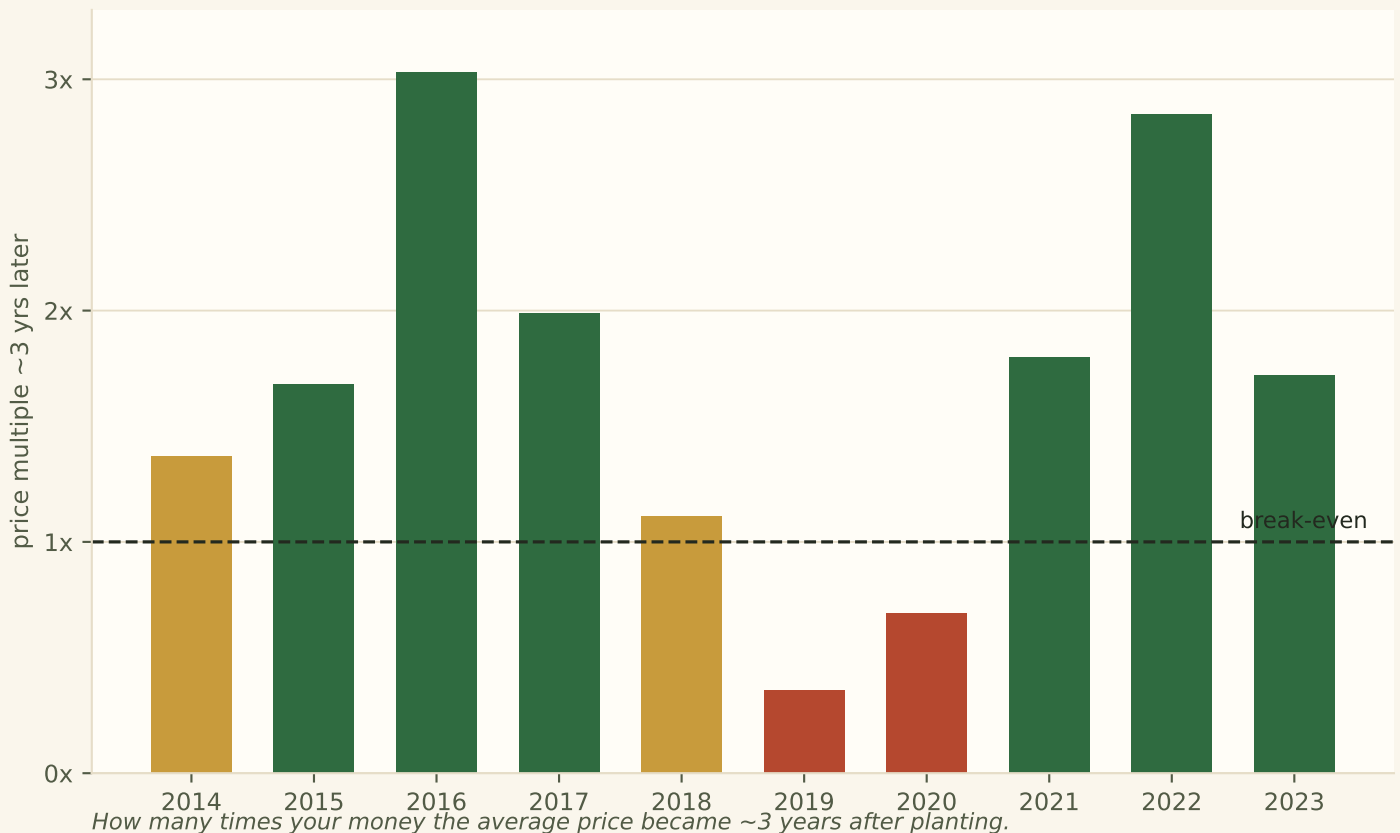
Prices run highest Jan, Jul, Aug, Sep - about 10-14% above the yearly average, with Aug the single strongest month. Holding stock for this window has paid roughly 15% more than selling in the weakest month.

THE TRAP MONTH

Oct is where holders get hurt - the steepest average drop of the year (-6.0% in a single month) as the main harvest floods in. If you are sitting on stock, do not drift into the autumn glut.

The planter's paradox

A new field takes about three years to bear fully. So the price that matters is not today's - it is the one waiting at harvest. History is brutally clear about when to plant.



THE GOLDEN WINDOW

Planting in 2016, when the average price was just Rs 824, meant harvesting into ~Rs 2,496 - 3.03x your money. Cheap, unloved years are the planter's friend: low prices today mean tight supply tomorrow.

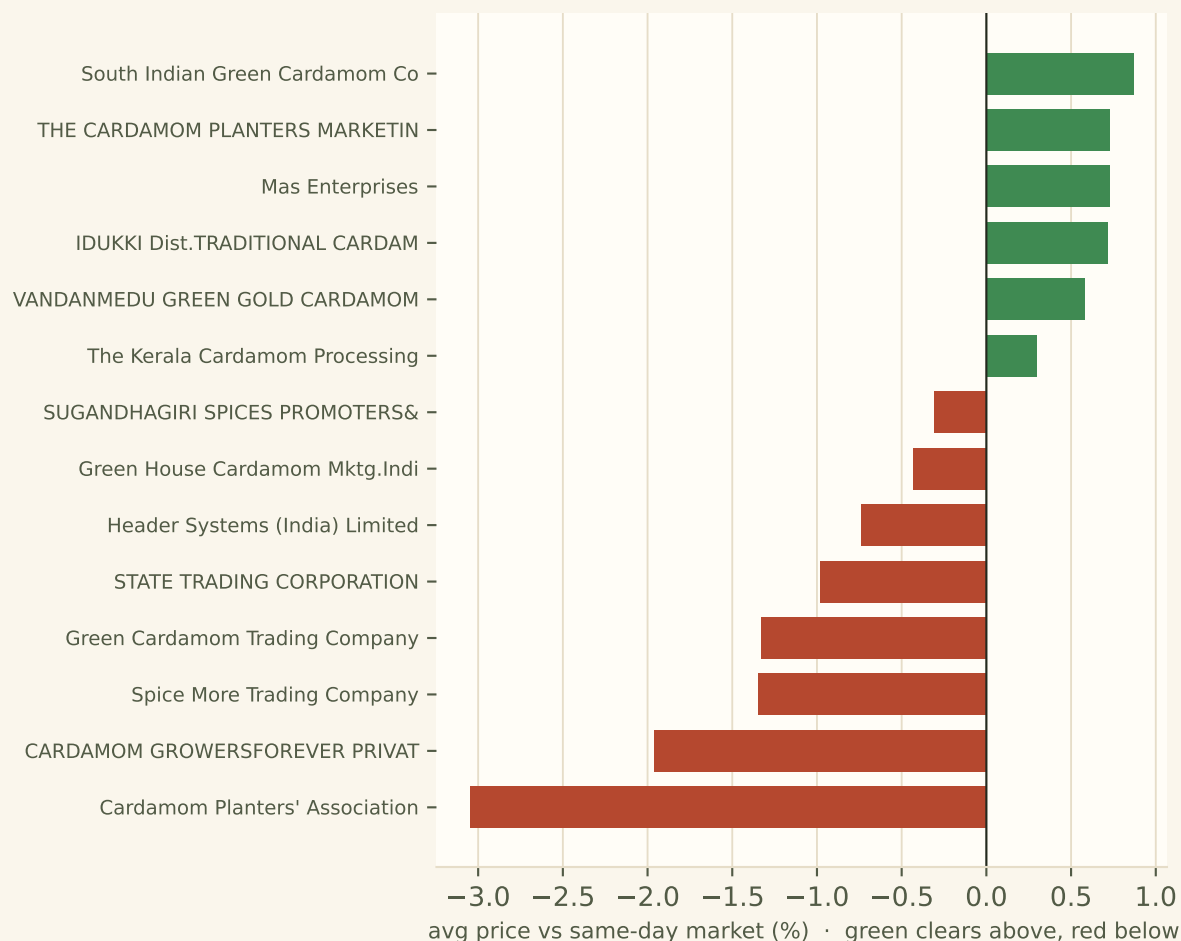
THE WIDOW-MAKER

Planting the 2019 euphoria at Rs 2,496 meant harvesting into Rs 903 - just 0.36x, a real loss. Buying into the hype is how growers get trapped.

"Plant into cheap prices, not into headlines."

Where you sell is worth money

On any given day two or three auction houses run their own sales - and they are not interchangeable. Against the same-day market, a stubborn pecking order appears.



+0.87%

top house premium

83%

days it beats market

-3.05%

weakest house

3.9%

best-worst gap

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

The gap between the best- and worst-clearing house is about 3.9% - on a tonne of cardamom that is real money, repeated at every sale. The strongest houses (led by South Indian Green Cardamom Company Lt) beat the market on most days; the weakest clear below it almost every time. Know where your lots land, and favour houses that consistently fetch more for comparable produce.

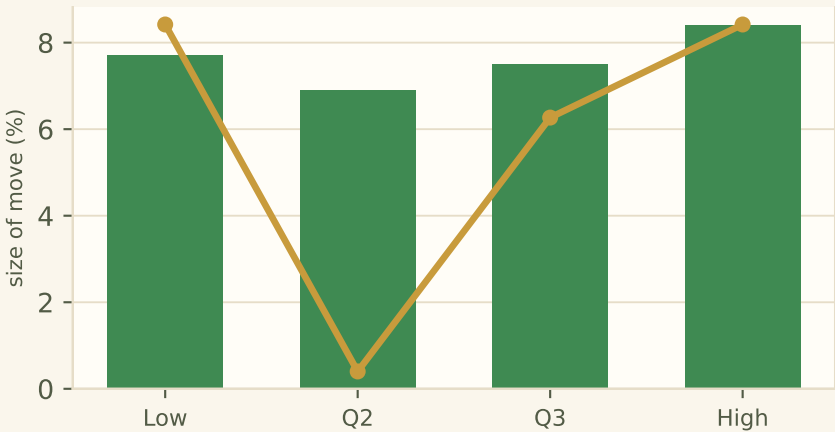
A market on a weekly clock

Each major house owns a weekday. Part of every daily wobble is just which house sold - not the market itself moving. And when the houses disagree, watch out.

WHO SELLS WHEN

Mas Enterprises	Saturday (44%)	South Indian Green Ca	Tuesday (42%)
Header Systems (India	Tuesday (41%)	The Kerala Cardamom P	Thursday (47%)
Green House Cardamom	Saturday (41%)	SUGANDHAGIRI SPICES P	Wednesday (44%)
IDUKKI Dist.TRADITION	Monday (45%)	CARDAMOM GROWERSFOREV	Friday (42%)

A quiet tell: when the houses disagree



READ THE SCATTER

When same-day prices scatter widely, the next two weeks tend to move more - and lean upward. Disagreement marks demand building under the surface.

THE GROWER'S PLAYBOOK

Six rules the data backs

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|------------------------------------|--|
| 1. Respect the cycle. | prices swing 9.4x - today is a moment, not a trend. |
| 2. Watch the rain, not the rumour. | monsoon & El Nino drive supply more than any tip. |
| 3. Sell into strength (Jan-Aug). | ~15% over the weakest month; dodge Oct. |
| 4. Plant cheap, never hot. | 2016 returned 3.03x; the 2019 peak lost money. |
| 5. Mind the auction house. | a 3.9% gap compounds at every sale. |
| 6. Read the disagreement. | scattered prices signal a bigger, upward move ahead. |